

puter because a single person could sit beside it and work!

IBM's Chamberlin And Boyce develop SQL

One of IBM's great gifts to programming was Structured Query Language (SQL). The first version of SQL, also called SEQUEL—Structured English Query Language—was developed by Donald Chamberlin and Raymond Boyce. Query languages are used to make specific information requests from databases. (A database is a collection of information organised in a structured manner such that a computer program can select desired pieces of data from it.) The name was changed from SEQUEL to SQL because a UK-based aircraft company had SEQUEL as a trademark.

Total Control

Dr Gary A Kildall, while employed with Intel, created CP/M (Control Program for Microprocessors) as an operating system for new microprocessors. Later, in 1977, CP/M became a popular operating system for microcomputers.

SQL was designed for manipulation and retrieval of data stored in the relational database System R, an original IBM product. SQL was standardised by the American National Standards Institute (ANSI). Variants of SQL have been created by SQL-Database Management System vendors; however, there were limitations to these like incompatibility with different vendor products, complex and vague language grammar, and lack of portability amongst cross-platform applications. Later in 1979, after Oracle was founded, it released the first commercial version of SQL.

1975: A Microsoft Milestone

April: Programmers Gates And Allen

Using BASIC, the programming language developed by John Kemeny and Thomas Krutz in 1963, Bill Gates and Paul Allen wrote a computer language for the Altair 8800. Gates and Allen then licensed BASIC to MITS for the Altair. Later, Gates dropped out